

October

14

2012

Space skydive

Austrian Felix Baumgartner became the first skydiver to break the speed of sound when he jumped from a balloon 39 km (24 miles) above Earth. He opened his parachute and landed near Roswell in New Mexico, USA, nine minutes later.

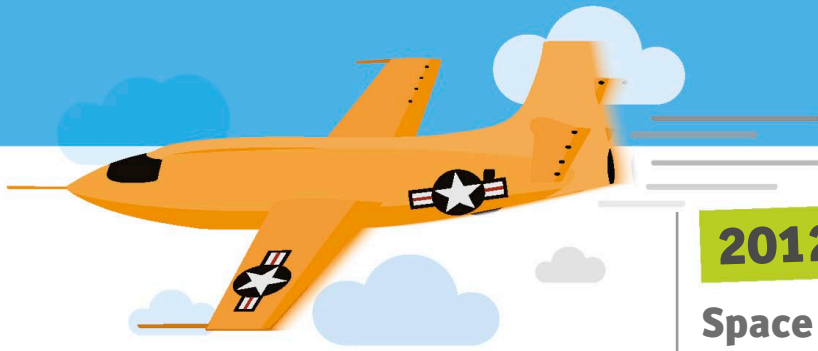


Born this day

1978 Usher, Black American singer and songwriter. One of the biggest names in modern R&B music, he has sold more than 100 million records worldwide.

1947 Speed of sound

With US pilot Charles “Chuck” Yeager at the controls, the experimental Bell X-1 rocket-powered plane reached a speed of 1,127 kph (700 mph), flying faster than the speed of sound. It was the first crewed aircraft to achieve this feat.



Also on this day

1962 In the build-up to the Cuban Missile Crisis, a US aircraft took photographs of Soviet ballistic missiles installed in Cuba, confirming the threat of a potential Soviet nuclear attack on the USA.

1968 Black American athlete Jim Hines ran the 100 m in 9.95 seconds, becoming the first person to do this in less than 10 seconds.

1066

Battle of Hastings

Duke William of Normandy killed King Harold II of England at the Battle of Hastings, defeating the Anglo-Saxon army. This victory allowed William’s Norman-French soldiers to take over England.

